

Advanced & Global Facial Techniques

India's Abhyanga, Japan's Kobido, China's Gua Sha, Korea's lymphatic art — the world's finest, taught with reverence

Learning Objectives

- Perform the foundational movements of Abhyanga, Kobido, and Gua Sha
- Understand the tradition, the evidence, and the contraindications of each
- Locate and work the principal marma points of the face
- Offer the world's great facial traditions with both skill and cultural respect

The inheritance of the whole world

Every great culture, given enough centuries, discovered the same truth: that skilled hands upon the face do something for a human being that no product ever can. In this module you become an inheritor of all of them — India's gift first, because it is your root, and then the world's beside it.

To perform a technique without knowing its homeland is to take. To perform it with its story held in your hands is to honour.

Abhyanga — the Indian art

Abhyanga is the Ayurvedic art of massage with warm oil, working along the body's marma points, the vital junctions where consciousness and physiology meet. Warm oil, chosen for the dosha, is worked with slow intention along these points and the lines of the face — nourishing the skin, calming the nervous system, easing the held tension of the jaw and brow.



The Origin BubbleIndia · Abhyanga · the warm oil

The Oil at Dawn

In the old way, it begins before the rest of the house is awake. The oil is warmed — sesame, most often, scented faintly with herbs — until it is the temperature of the body itself. The grandmother tests it against the inside of her own wrist, because oil too hot is oil that does not love you.

Then the hands begin. Not quickly. The oil is worked into the scalp, down the neck, across the face along lines the hands seem to know without being told. The child being oiled grows heavy-lidded. Outside, the light comes up slowly over the courtyard.

No one in that room calls it therapy. It is simply what is done — the oldest thing one body can say to another: *you are cared for. Be still. All is well.*

The tradition

Abhyanga is one of the central daily practices of Ayurveda, practised across India for thousands of years. Modern study confirms what the grandmother knew: slow, warm-oil massage genuinely lowers the body's stress response, improves circulation, and nourishes the skin's barrier.

The technique you will learn: The facial *Abhyanga* and the principal marma points of the face — taught with the reverence a living tradition deserves.

Kobido — the Japanese art

Kobido — the Japanese "ancient way of beauty," born in the imperial courts in 1472 and passed for five centuries from master to single apprentice. Its hallmark is speed: rapid, rhythmic, drumming movements that awaken the skin and stimulate circulation.



The Origin BubbleJapan · Kobido · 1472

The Hands That Were Given Once

The story they tell is that it began with two masters of *anma* who were summoned to ease the empress, and who devised, for her face alone, something finer than anything done before. It pleased the court so greatly it was not written down — given, instead, from one pair of hands to one pair of hands.

For five hundred years it travelled this way, each master choosing, in a lifetime, perhaps one or two souls worthy to receive it.

When you raise your hands to learn even its first movements, pause and feel the weight of that.

The tradition

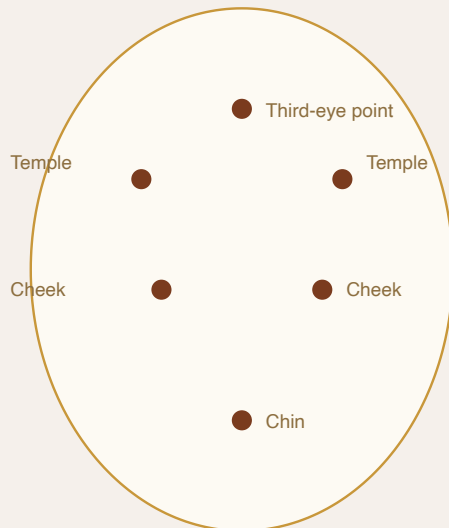
Kobido traces to 1472 in Japan, historically transmitted only master-to-apprentice. Its rapid, rhythmic technique stimulates circulation and lymphatic flow.

The technique you will learn: *Kobido*'s foundational rhythms — and the humility to know you are at the beginning of a long road.

Gua Sha and the Korean lymphatic art

- **Gua Sha** — from traditional Chinese medicine, gentle scraping with a smooth tool along the contours of the face. Encourages drainage and circulation; the dramatic claims outrun the proof, but genuine benefits are real.
- **Korean lymphatic drainage** — the gentle, systematic techniques at the heart of the K-beauty facial. The philosophy of gentleness from Module Six, made into movement.

◆ Figure 12.1 · The Marma Points & the Four Global Techniques



● **Abhyanga**
India · warm oil, marma points

● **Kobido**
Japan · rapid rhythmic strokes

● **Gua Sha**
China · smooth-tool scraping

● **Korean Lymphatic**
Korea · gentle drainage art

The principal facial marma points, beside the four global techniques and their homelands.

The common thread

India warmed oil and worked the marma points at dawn. Japan drummed the face awake in the imperial court. China scraped jade along the cheekbone. Korea drained and brightened with

the gentlest touch. Four cultures, four philosophies, all arriving at the same human truth: *that the face, touched with skill and care, gives back something no jar can hold.*

Key Terms

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Practical Activity · The World in Your Hands

Choose one of the four techniques from this module. Learn its foundational sequence and perform it. Write a short reflection that includes both halves: the *technique* and the *tradition*. **Never the proof without the poetry — show me you can hold both.**